

Spelling — Silent Letters (Advanced)

Year 5 · gn, mn, gh

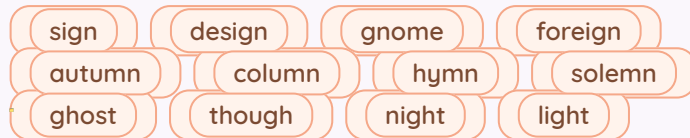
ACARA V9.0 — AC9E5LY08, AC9E5LY09 (Phonic, morphemic and vocabulary knowledge: word origins and spelling generalisations)

Learning Intention: Students will identify, spell, and use words featuring **gn**, **mn**, **gh**, and apply a strategy for remembering tricky spellings.

Pattern Focus

Some letter combinations include a silent letter carried over from the word's origin: **gn** is silent at the start (sign) or has a silent g before n, **mn** is silent at the end (autumn), and **gh** is often silent (night, though).

This Week's Words (12)



Write Each Word

sign		design	
gnome		foreign	
autumn		column	
hymn		solemn	
ghost		though	
night		light	

Sort the Words

Word bank: autumn, column, design, foreign, ghost, gnome, hymn, light, night, sign, solemn, though

gn

mn

gh

Find & Fix

Circle the misspelled word, then write it correctly:

sine →

disine →

autum →

colum →

gost →

nite →

Dictation Sentences (read aloud, student writes)

1. Sign the design near the column. 2. The gnome sat in autumn leaves. 3. We sang a solemn hymn. 4. The ghost appeared at night. 5. Though it was dark, the light shone.

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Proofread the Paragraph

Find and circle 5 spelling mistakes, then write the paragraph correctly on the lines below:

Sine the disine near the colum. The gost appeared at nite.

.....

.....

.....

Extension — Write Your Own

Pick 3 words from this set and write your own sentences:

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Complete the Sentence

Word bank: sign, autumn, light, ghost, night

1. Please your name here.
2. Leaves fall in
3. Turn on the
4. The scared us.
5. We saw stars at

Assessment — Spelling Test

Say each word, have the student write it, then check together:

 sign  design  autumn  column  ghost  night

Bonus Sentence: In autumn, the ghost appeared at night near the old column.

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Score:      / 6

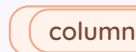
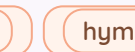
Next Steps: ☐ Ready for next pattern ☐ Needs more practice with this pattern ☐ Revisit in 2 weeks

Word Search

N	V	G	N	O	M	E	V	T	U
G	C	C	S	O	L	E	M	N	T
I	U	R	V	T	H	G	I	N	H
S	U	Y	L	I	G	H	T	N	O
N	G	I	E	R	O	F	X	M	U
E	P	Z	C	A	Y	D	P	Y	G
A	U	T	U	M	N	B	B	H	H
C	O	L	U	M	N	U	S	F	Z
Z	V	G	H	O	S	T	I	U	H
E	N	G	I	S	E	D	K	K	O

Find all 12 words in the grid:

 sign  design  gnome  foreign  autumn

 column  hymn  solemn  ghost  though

 night  light

Parent/Teacher Tip: These silent-letter patterns come from a word's history (Old English, French, Greek) rather than a phonics rule — treat them as words to learn by sight and frequent writing, not by sounding out.

For teachers and parents: use this page to check student responses across both worksheet pages.

Sort the Words

gn: sign, design, gnome, foreign
mn: autumn, column, hymn, solemn
gh: ghost, though, night, light

Find & Fix

sine → sign disine → design autum → autumn colum
→ column gost → ghost nite → night

Complete the Sentence

1. sign 2. autumn 3. light 4. ghost 5. night

Spelling Test Words

sign, design, autumn, column, ghost, night

Bonus: In autumn, the ghost appeared at night near the old column.

Proofread the Paragraph — Corrected Version

Sign the design near the column. The ghost appeared at night.

Dictation Sentences — Reference Spelling

1. Sign the design near the column.
2. The gnome sat in autumn leaves.
3. We sang a solemn hymn.
4. The ghost appeared at night.
5. Though it was dark, the light shone.

Word Search — All 12 Words

sign, design, gnome, foreign, autumn, column, hymn, solemn, ghost, though, night, light — placed horizontally, vertically, and diagonally throughout the grid.